Whistleblower and tip triage

Reading the best tips first

Status: Draft v0.1 (2026-11-04), for Steve's review. Extension 9 of 10 (see the extensions overview). Reference code: `analytics/triage/tips.py` (rule baseline and Claude scorer), tested on synthetic tips only.

Bottom line

Inspector General hotlines receive hundreds of thousands of contacts a year, and many of the largest fraud cases started with an insider tip. The bottleneck is reading: specific, checkable tips sit in the same queue as vague grievances and duplicates. This extension uses an AI model to **order the queue and summarize each tip**, never to close one. A person still reads every tip; the model changes which ones they read first.

- **Two scorers, one output.** A transparent rule-based score is the baseline and fallback. A Claude-based score reads the tip for program, scheme, specifics, urgency and whistleblower status, and returns a structured assessment with reasons.
- **Safeguards built in:** urgent tips (risk to life, destruction of evidence) jump the queue; tipsters who appear to be employees or contractors are flagged so whistleblower protections apply; the tip text is treated as data, so instructions inside a tip are ignored.
- **The pilot measures one thing:** how many of the tips that were later substantiated would have been in the top 20% of the queue.

1. Where tips come from

Hotline	Volume and notes
HHS-OIG hotline	Largest federal OIG hotline; health care fraud
DoD Hotline	Defense contracts and personnel
SBA OIG hotline	Pandemic loans drove a large backlog
DOL-OIG	UI fraud
GAO FraudNet	Government-wide
Agency program integrity lines, state Medicaid Fraud Control Units	Program specific
False Claims Act qui tam complaints	Filed under seal with DOJ; out of scope for this tool

2. What the model returns

Field	Meaning
score (0-100)	Actionability: specific, checkable facts score high
priority	urgent, high, normal or low
program, scheme	From fixed lists, so tips can be routed and counted
summary	Two neutral sentences, no conclusions about guilt
reasons	Why the score is what it is
entities	Named people, firms and identifiers, as written
whistleblower_protection	The tipster appears to be an employee, contractor or grantee staff member
scorer	"rules" or "claude+rules", so every score is traceable

The model's score is blended with the rule score (70/30 by default), and the rule score is used alone if the model is unavailable or declines.

3. Rule baseline

Points for naming a program and a scheme, amounts, dates, addresses, identifiers (NPI, UEI, contract numbers), an insider account and mentions of evidence; points off for very short tips and general grievance language. Crude on purpose: it sets the floor the model must beat, and its reasons are easy to check.

4. Model and hosting

- **Model:** Claude (`claude-opus-5-5` by default) through the Anthropic Python SDK, with a JSON-schema output format so every answer has the same fields, low effort to keep cost per tip small, and server-side refusal fallback enabled.
- **Hosting:** tips contain personal data about tipsters and subjects. The model must run in an environment authorized for that data: an OIG's FedRAMP-authorized cloud tenancy (Claude is available on government cloud regions of the major providers; check current authorization levels) or the agency's own enclave. No tip goes to a commercial endpoint without that authorization, and the provider must not retain or train on the data.
- **Cost:** a typical tip is a few hundred words; at low effort the cost per tip is a small fraction of a cent to a few cents, far below the cost of an analyst's minute.

5. Safeguards

- **No automated closure.** The tool orders and summarizes; people decide.
- **Prompt injection:** tip text is wrapped and marked as data; the system prompt tells the model to ignore instructions inside it. The pilot test set includes tips that try to instruct the model.
- **Whistleblower protection:** flagged tips are routed under the OIG's confidentiality procedures (IG Act, 5 U.S.C. 407(b)); the tipster's identity is not shared with the program office.
- **Bias:** score distributions are compared by language, program and region of the tip, and tips written in other languages are translated rather than penalized.
- **Audit trail:** original text, both scores, reasons and model version are kept with every tip.



6. Pilot design (60 days, one OIG)

1. Take a closed historical set of 2,000 to 5,000 tips with known outcomes (substantiated, referred, closed) inside the OIG's environment.
2. Score them blind with both scorers.
3. Measure recall in the top 20% and lift over the current order; compare model and rules.
4. Hand-check 200 model summaries for accuracy and neutrality.
5. Pass mark: the model finds at least 1.5 times as many substantiated tips in the top 20% as the current process, with summaries rated accurate in at least 95% of checks.

7. Questions for Steve

1. Which OIG hotline is the most likely partner: HHS-OIG (largest) or SBA OIG (existing relationship)?
2. Are we comfortable proposing a model provider, or should the proposal stay model-neutral and name Claude as the reference implementation?